

Darkness - Ignorance and oppression

Poetic and Stylistic techniques -

Alliteration, Assonance, Asyndeton,
Consonance, Enjambment, Imagery,
Metaphor

3. Spain -

Central Message - Spanish Civil War
and presence the

Conflict as part of larger struggle
between fascism and the forces
fighting for freedom and social
change.

Poetic form - Free verse / Irregular
Verse

Themes - War, Political conflict, Sacrifice,
death and suffering, Hope

Emotions - Anger, Sympathy, Grief, Fear,
Hope, Idealism, Doubt, Moral
Conflict.

Summary -

The poem begins by looking at Spain's

past and the long history that has led to
the present situation. Auden then
describes the country in middle of war,
where soldiers are fighting and ordinary
people are suffering.

He mentions different group of people -
workers, farmers, scientists, artists and
soldiers and describes how their work and
sufferings are connected with the future of
Spain.

The poet also imagines the future that
may come after the war, when people may
enjoy peace, knowledge, freedom and
a better life. However, he reminds us
that this future has to be achieved
through great sacrifice and the loss of
many lives.

Symbolism - Past, present and future -
Human civilization and sacrifices
made for future progress.

Poetic and Stylistic techniques -

Imagery, Metaphor, Personification, Allusion,
Contrast, Irony

05/09/26

Unit-3

Date			
Page No.	242		

Samuel Beckett - Waiting for Godot D

Summary and Context -

This is one of the best known works of Theater of the Absurd, a form of drama that rejects the traditional plot, logical action and clear resolution of conventional theatre.

It revolves around two characters - Vladimir and Estragon, who meet near a tree and wait for a man named Godot. They are unsure when he will arrive or exactly what he will do, but they continue waiting because they believe his arrival will change their situation.

About the writer -

Samuel Beckett (1906-1989)

Era & Age - Postmodern Age,
Contemporary Period (1945 - present)

Titles - Fathers of the Theatre of Absurd

Admires - Modern dramatists, Theatre

Date			
Page No.	243		

critics

Critics - Plays meaningless

Contribution -

- Developed Absurd Drama
- Explores human existence and uncertainty
- Revolutionized modern theatre.

Waiting for Godot -

While waiting, Vladimir and Estragon, talk, argue, joke, remember things imperfectly, and repeatedly consider leaving. Pozzo and Lucky also appear and have a strange master-servant relationship.

Later, a boy arrives and tells them that Godot will not come that day but will come tomorrow. The two men decide to leave, but remain where they are. The play therefore ends with the same waiting with which it began.

Major Themes - The Absurdity of Human Existence, Waiting, Hope, Time (like a repetitive cycle), Memory and Forgetting

Symbolism -

The Tree - Dead then leaves appear, life, Hope, Change, Renewal

Godot - God, Salvation, Purpose, Meaning, Future Change

The Road - Journey, Possibility, Movement, Freedom

Characters - Appearance, Qualities and Representation

→ Wears old, worn clothing
 → Thoughtful, Philosophical, Patient, Caring, Hopeful
 Vladimir (Didi) → Intellectual, Thinking Side of Humanity

→ Worn old clothes, struggle with boots
 Estragon → Forgetful, emotional, impulsive, Physical, Vulnerable
 (Gogo) → physical, instinctive and Subversive Side of Humanity

→ Wealthy landowner / traveler
 Pozzo → arrogant, cruel
 → Power, authority, wealth

→ Pozzo's servant, rope around his neck
 Lucky → Obedient, Exhausted, Submissive
 → Oppression, Slavery, exploited workers, loss of freedom

→ Never physically appears
 Godot → God, Salvation, Hope, meaning, purpose or an unexpected future

Important Quotes -

1. "Nothing to be done." - Estragon

Opening line of play. Atmosphere of hopelessness, passivity, frustration and absurdity.

2. "Nothing happens, nobody comes, nobody goes, it's awful!" - Estragon

Perfectly summarizes structure of the play.

3. "We're waiting for Godot." - Vladimir

Basic purpose of characters existence.

05/03/26

Robert Lynd - Why we Hate Insects,
The pleasure of Ignorance NO

About the writer -

Robert Lynd (1879-1949)

Era & Age - Modern age, Modern
period (1901-1945)

Titles - Master of the Familiar Essay

Address - Essayists, literary readers

Critics - Essays as overly informal

Contribution -

- Enriched personal essay writing
- Used humor and reflection.
- Made ordinary experiences literary

1. Why We Hate Insects -

Summary and context -

A humorous but deeply thoughtful essay. It starts by discussing why humans hate insects, but gradually becomes a discussion about fear,

prejudice, cruelty and the danger of treating living beings as "vermin". The essay appears as Chapter X of Lynd's 'The pleasure of Ignorance' (1921).

Robert Lynd asks a simple question: Why do human beings hate insects?

He observes that our dislike is not always based on actual danger. For example, people may be terrified of a harmless spider but remain calm around a dangerous wasp or honeybee. Thus, our fear of insects is often irrational rather than proportional to real threat they pose.

Lynd discusses several insects:

- Spiders - Often feared despite not necessarily being dangerous.
- Fleas and lice - hated because people often associate them with dirt and disease.
- Moths - frightening to many people because of their mysterious movement at night.
- Flies - considered annoying and dirty, but Lynd questions the cruelty with

which humans sometimes kill them.

- Bees and butterflies/ladybirds - examples of insects that humans can admire because they appear beautiful or useful.

The essay's most important argument comes near the end. Human calls insects "vermin" and destroys them without much sympathy.

Lynch warns that this attitude can also be applied to human beings. Once we began to regard a person as an insect or vermin, it becomes easier to treat that person without compassion.

So, the essay is not merely about insects - it is about human prejudice and cruelty.

Themes - Fear and Irrationality, Beauty vs Ugliness, Human prejudice, Cruelty, Dehumanization, Human Relationship with Nature.

Important Quotes -

1. "Our fears, it is evident, do not march in all respects with our sense of physical danger." - Human fear, psychology, Irrationality.

2. "Moths are the ghosts of the insect world."

Symbolism, beauty vs terror

3. "To regard a human being as an insect is always the first step in treating him without remorse."

Morality, prejudice, Dehumanization

2. The pleasure of Ignorance -

Summary and Context -

A humorous and philosophical essay in which Lynch argues that not knowing everything can actually make life more enjoyable.

Usually, people think ignorance is something bad and knowledge is always desirable. Lynch challenges this idea. He says that if we knew everything about the world already, curiosity, wonder and discovery would disappear.

For dynd, ignorance gives us the opportunity to ask questions, observe nature and enjoy the mysteries of everyday life.

Major Themes - The pleasure of Curiosity, Mystery and Wonder, Knowledge Vs Ignorance, Appreciation of nature, Childlike Wonder, Humour and Irony

Important Quotes -

1. "The pleasures of Ignorance are as great as the pleasures of knowledge." - Knowledge Vs Ignorance
2. "The world is full of things which we do not understand." - Curiosity, Mystery, Nature

Khushwant Singh - The Train to Pakistan
NO

Summary and Context -

Novel begins in Mano Rajra, a small village near the border between India and Pakistan. The village is unusual because Sikhs and Muslims live together peacefully. There is a railway bridge near the village, and trains regularly pass through. Partition brings fear, violence and hatred.

A money lender named Ram Lal is murdered, and suspicion falls on a local Sikh dacoit, Juggat Singh (Jugga). At the same time, a muslim stranger named Iqbal arrives in the village. The authorities arrest both Jugga and Iqbal.

About the writer -

Khushwant Singh (1915-2014)

Era and Age - Contemporary Indian Literature, Contemporary period (1947 - Present)

Titles - Voice of Partition Literature

Admirees - Indian readers, Historians

Critics - Style too direct

Contribution -

- Portrayal Partition realistically
- Combined history and fiction
- Popularized Indian English fiction

The Train to Pakistan -

Trains carrying refugees begin arriving from Pakistan. Soon, the villagers discover that some of these trains are filled with the dead bodies of people killed during the communal violence, making the situation in Mano Majra extremely tense.

The government eventually decides to evacuate the Muslims to Pakistan. Before they leave, a plan is made by extremists to attack the train carrying the Muslim refugees by placing the rope across the railway bridge so that people on the train will be killed.

Jugga, who loves Nooran, a Muslim

girl whose family is being forced to leave, learns about the plan. Although he is considered a criminal and has been arrested, Jugga escapes and secretly goes to the bridge.

0609126

He cuts the rope, saving the train and the people aboard it, but is shot and killed in the process. The novel ends with Jugga sacrificing his life for love and humanity, showing that personal loyalty and human compassion can survive even during communal hatred and violence.

Major Themes - Partition and communal violence, Humanity above religion, Love, Sacrifice, Religion vs Humanity

Major Symbols -

1. The Train - Beginning → Routine, Time, Connection, Normal life

Partition → Refugees, death, Violence and displacement

End → Movement, Separation and Survival

2. The Railway Bridge - Connection, Separation, Borders, Transition, Life

and death.

3. The Ghost Train - Death, partition, loss of humanity

Characters - Appearance, Qualities, Representation

→ Young Sikh man, strong and physically powerful
Juggut Singh → Brave, hot-tempered, loyal, (Jugga)
 Emotional, protective
 → Humanity beyond religious identity

→ Young Muslim women, pregnant with Jugga's child
Noorian → Loving, emotional, vulnerable
 → Innocent human life caught in the violence of partition

→ Educated, urban/intellectual
Iqbal → Intelligent, idealistic, analytical
 → Intellectual idealism and political theory

Important Quotes -

1. "The world has become a place where men are killing each other."

Violence Surrounding Partition.

2. "The train was coming from Pakistan."

Train represent partition itself.

3. "What is a country? Is it the people or the land?"

Questions the meaning of national identity.